

Vike Marketing — First Client to First 10: A Realistic 30/60/90-Day Plan

Confidential internal research · vikemarketing.com

Prepared: 2026-09-20 | **Founder capacity:** ~16 hrs/week (solo) | **Channel priority:** free/cheap organic + outbound (paid ads on hold)

0. Executive Framing — the honest starting position

Vike Marketing has real assets and real gaps. This plan is built to use the assets aggressively and route around the gaps rather than pretend they don't exist.

Real assets:

- Three genuine client outcomes: Junior School (Lviv preschool) got leads within a month; Mary (author, Israel) sold out her first book batch in 60 days; Alex (construction startup, Kyiv) got ongoing social media management. These are usable, specific, true proof points — not generic "we grow brands" claims.
- A founder who is B2+/C1 English, strategically capable on ads, and has 16 structured hours/week to commit.
- Google Business Profile live; Clutch profile in review; LinkedIn page exists.
- Three clean, honest, no-contract price points (\$200/\$400/\$750) that undercut most agency minimums in Ireland/Netherlands and fit Ukrainian SMB budgets.

Real gaps — addressed head-on, not glossed over:

- **No public reviews yet** (no Google reviews, no Clutch reviews). This matters: 93% of consumers read reviews before deciding, and 85% trust online reviews as much as personal recommendations ([Capital One Shopping, 2026 review stats](#); [SocialPilot, 2026](#)). Vike has zero of this social proof today. The plan's core job in the first 90 days is to manufacture the first 2-3 reviews/testimonials as fast as possible, because every day without them is a day of lower conversion on every channel.
- **Solo founder, no formal team.** The cofounder friend and UGC creator are informal/unconfirmed — this plan assumes Vladyslav alone for capacity math. Overstating team size in outreach would be dishonest and is explicitly avoided in every template below.
- **Site not yet indexed by Google.** SEO/organic search cannot be a week 1-13 acquisition channel for Vike itself — it's a proof-of-craft demonstration to show prospects later, not a lead source in this window.
- **New domain for cold email.** A brand-new sending domain lands in the inbox only ~12% of the time without warm-up, vs. ~87% once properly warmed ([SalesTarget.ai, 2026](#); [OneAway, 2026](#)).

Cold email to Ireland/Netherlands prospects is therefore sequenced to start in week 3-5, after warm-up, not week 1.

- **Capacity ceiling.** See §7 — hitting "10 clients" solo at 16 hrs/week by day 90 is an upper-bound stretch, not the base case. This is stated plainly rather than smoothed over.

1. Ranked ICPs — likelihood to buy in the next 30-60 days, with rationale

Ranking is by **realistic near-term buying likelihood given Vike's actual proof and trust position today**, not by long-term market size (Ireland/Netherlands are the bigger prize longer-term — see §1.5).

1st — Preschools / child development centers (Lviv & wider Ukraine)

Why #1: This is the *only* ICP with a direct, same-category proof point: Junior School, a Lviv preschool, got leads within a month of working with Vike. A prospect in the exact same category, in the exact same city, can be told "we did this for a preschool like yours, here" — the single strongest sales sentence available to Vike right now. Add to that: same language/culture (Ukrainian, in-person meetings possible), short decision chains (usually one owner/director decides), low ad budgets that fit the \$200 Launch tier exactly, and a category that runs on local lead generation (parents searching "дитячий садок [район]") which is Vike's core competency (Meta + Google local lead gen). Geographic proximity also means Vladyslav can genuinely visit, which no EU cold-email competitor can offer a Lviv business owner.

2nd — Dental clinics (Lviv & wider Ukraine)

Why #2: Same structural advantages as preschools (local, Ukrainian-language, short sales cycle, founder can meet in person) but **without** a direct same-category case study — the closest proof is an adjacent local-services win (Junior School) plus Alex's social media management result, which is a believable but not identical analogy. Dental clinics also have materially higher realistic budgets than preschools (private, cash-pay, competitive local market), fitting the \$400 Scale tier, and they compete hard on Google/Maps visibility for terms like "стоматологія Львів," which plays directly to Vike's paid ads + GBP optimization skill set. Ranked below preschools only because the proof-point match is one step less direct.

3rd — Ireland & Netherlands English-speaking SMBs

Why #3, despite being the strategic long-term priority: Budget fit is genuinely strong — Irish SMEs typically spend €600-3,000/month on digital marketing ([VIMAR, 2026](#)), well above Vike's \$750 ceiling, meaning Vike is priced as a genuine bargain there; Ireland's digital ad market crossed €1.1bn in 2025 with 8% YoY growth ([ppc.land](#)), and the Netherlands digital ad market is worth ~\$3.8-4.1bn and growing ~9%/year ([Yahoo Finance/ResearchAndMarkets, 2026](#)). But this is a **cold**, foreign-agency, review-less pitch to a market that is used to vetting vendors carefully — the trust deficit is at its worst here. It's ranked 3rd for near-term conversion, not because the opportunity is smaller, but because Vike currently has zero proof points from this market or category. Strategy: use Ireland/NL as a volume-building cold-email/LinkedIn channel from week 3

onward in parallel, expecting a slower, lower-probability close, while local wins (ICP #1/#2) generate the case studies that will make Ireland/NL outreach convert better in weeks 9-13 and beyond.

4th — E-commerce SMBs (any geography)

Why #4: Longest-term opportunity, least ready today. E-commerce buyers evaluate agencies almost entirely on hard ROAS/CAC numbers and portfolio proof — the category where Vike's current proof (leads for a preschool, book sales for an author, social management for a construction startup) transfers least directly. No e-commerce case study exists yet, and Google Ads is explicitly on hold, removing one of the two channels (Google Shopping/Search) e-commerce clients care most about. This ICP is deliberately deprioritized until at least one e-commerce or e-commerce-adjacent pilot result exists (a construction/product business counts as a partial bridge).

Sources: [VIMAR — Irish digital marketing costs](#) · [ppc.land — Ireland digital ad spend 2025](#) · [Yahoo Finance/ResearchAndMarkets — Netherlands digital ad spend 2026](#)

2. Channel-by-Channel Playbook

2.1 Cold Email (primary channel for Ireland/Netherlands, secondary for Ukraine niches)

Benchmarks (cite, not assumed):

- Average B2B cold email reply rate in 2026 is **3.43%**, down from 8.5% in 2019 and 5% in 2025 — the channel has gotten harder, not easier. A reply rate above 5% is "good"; above 10% is top-tier ([Instantly.ai Cold Email Benchmark Report 2026](#)).
- A "good" meeting-booked rate is **0.8-1.5% of emails sent**; best-in-class (tight ICP + strong offer + clean infrastructure) reaches 2-3% ([LeadHaste, 2026](#)).
- Deliverability collapses without domain warm-up: a brand-new, unwarmed domain lands in the inbox only ~12% of the time vs. ~87% once warmed ([SalesTarget.ai](#)). Run **3-4 weeks of gradual warm-up** before any real sending, starting at ~5-10 emails/day and scaling up ([Mailforge.ai](#); [Unify GTM](#)).
- Safe sending volume once warmed: **50-100/day per mailbox**; sending above 150/day per mailbox correlates with 43% higher spam-complaint rates ([Topo.io](#)). Vike will never need this volume solo — quality/personalization matters more than volume at this scale.
- **GDPR compliance for Ireland/Netherlands cold email:** B2B cold email is legal under GDPR's "legitimate interest" basis (Article 6(1)(f) / Recital 47) provided you email role-based business addresses (not personal), identify yourself clearly, state a genuine business reason, and provide a one-click opt-out. Ireland and the Netherlands are both jurisdictions that permit role-based B2B outreach without prior consent (unlike Germany/Italy, which require it) — this is a factor in why they're the right first EU markets ([Sales Force Europe](#); [RocketSDR](#)). Penalties for non-compliance are severe (up to €20M / 4% of global revenue) — always include a real sender address, real opt-out, and never scrape personal (non-work) emails.

Setup (Week 1-2, before any sending):

1. Use a subdomain of vikemarketing.com (e.g., [hello.vikemarketing.com](#)) or a dedicated Page 3 of 15

vikemarketing-outreach.com) — never burn the main domain's reputation on cold outreach.

2. Set SPF, DKIM, DMARC correctly (free, one-time setup via Netlify DNS / domain registrar).
3. Start automated warm-up (e.g., a free-tier warm-up tool) for 3-4 weeks in parallel with local-channel outreach (§1 ICP #1/#2), so email is ready exactly when local momentum needs a second channel.

Sequence (3-touch, 9 days) — Ireland/Netherlands SMB template:

Email 1 (Day 0) — Subject: quick one about [Business Name]'s [Google/Meta] ads

Hi [First Name],

I run Vike Marketing, a small performance-marketing team — we manage paid ads, SEO and social for SMBs on a month-to-month basis, no contracts.

I had a quick look at [Business Name]'s [website/Google Business Profile/Instagram] and noticed [one specific, true observation — e.g., "your Google Business Profile doesn't show any recent posts" or "I couldn't find a Meta ad running for [product/service] even though [competitor] is actively advertising"].

I put together a free growth audit for businesses like yours — a short breakdown of 2-3 concrete things that are likely costing you customers right now, no strings attached. Want me to send it over?

Vladyslav

Vike Marketing — vikemarketing.com

Email 2 (Day 3) — Subject: Re: quick one about [Business Name]'s [Google/Meta] ads

Hi [First Name], following up in case this got buried.

To be concrete about what's in the audit: I'll check your [Google Business Profile setup / site speed & mobile experience / current ad account if you're running one] and send back 2-3 specific fixes — takes me under an hour, costs you nothing.

Worth 10 minutes?

Vladyslav

Email 3 (Day 8) — Subject: closing the loop

Hi [First Name], I'll leave this here — if it's ever useful, the offer stands (free audit, no pitch attached unless you want one).

One data point in case it's helpful: we recently helped a client sell through their first product batch in 60 days purely through better targeting and messaging, on a \$200-750/month retainer with no lock-in contract.

All the best,

Vladyslav

Local Ukraine variant (preschools/dental — used where email address is known, otherwise prefer Instagram DM/phone, see 2.3):

Subject: щодо просування [Назва садочка/клініки]

Доброго дня, [Ім'я]!

Мене звати Владислав, я керую Vike Marketing — ми ведемо рекламу та соцмережі для малого бізнесу у Львові. Нещодавно ми запустили рекламу для [Junior School, дитячого садочка у Львові] — перші заявки з'явилися протягом місяця.

Можу безкоштовно перевірити ваш Google-профіль та Instagram і надіслати 2-3 конкретні речі, які, ймовірно, коштують вам клієнтів зараз. Без жодних зобов'язань — цікаво?

Владислав, Vike Marketing

(Use the client's real name only with their comfort/permission — see the note in §5. If unconfirmed, say "дитячого садочка у Львові" without naming it.)

2.2 LinkedIn Outreach (primary for Ireland/Netherlands decision-makers, secondary awareness channel elsewhere)

Benchmarks:

- Platform-wide average connection acceptance rate is **~28.5%**; a healthy realistic band for cold outreach to net-new prospects is **21-38%** ([Expandi.io 2026 Benchmark](#)).
- Reply rate on a message sent *after* connection is accepted averages **10.4%**; 7-10% is considered good in 2026 ([Reachium 2026](#)).
- A **personalized** connection note lifts reply rate to ~9.36% vs. ~5.44% for a blank request — always personalize the note ([Expandi.io](#)).
- Reply rates are trending down year-over-year (32.19% among accepted connections in 2025 vs. 21.98% in 2026) — a reminder that LinkedIn is getting noisier, so specificity matters more each quarter ([Reachium — The Reply Rate Collapse](#)).

Process:

1. Optimize Vladyslav's LinkedIn profile first (Week 1): headline states "Founder, Vike Marketing — Performance Marketing for SMBs (Meta/Google Ads, SEO, Social)"; featured section links vikemarketing.com and the three testimonials as text posts (not fabricated logos/case-study graphics — plain honest quotes).
2. Build a list of 15-20 target connections/week: owners/marketing leads at Irish/Dutch SMBs in service categories that run local/e-commerce ads (dentists, clinics, home services, small e-commerce brands, education).
3. Send connection request with a 1-2 sentence personalized note (never a pitch in the note itself — pitch only after acceptance).

Connection note template:

Hi [First Name] — came across [Business Name] while researching [Dublin/Amsterdam] SMBs doing [category] marketing. I run a small performance-marketing agency and would

First message after acceptance (Day 0-1):

Thanks for connecting, [First Name]! Quick context: I run Vike Marketing — we manage Meta/Google ads, SEO and social for SMBs, month-to-month, no contracts, starting at \$200/mo. I noticed [specific, true observation about their online presence]. I put together a free growth audit — want me to run one for [Business Name]? No pitch, just the findings.

Follow-up (Day 4, if no reply): short bump — "No pressure at all — happy to send the audit whenever's useful, or not if it's not a priority right now."

2.3 Instagram DM Outreach (primary for local Lviv preschools/dental clinics with active IG, secondary for small EU brands)

Benchmarks: Cold Instagram DM response rates for well-targeted, personalized outreach to an ICP run **10-25%**, with generic/template blasts closer to 3-10% ([Cold DM Calculator, 2026](#); [LeadResponse, 2026](#)). Treat the higher end of these vendor-published numbers as optimistic and plan around the low-to-mid end (10-15%) for a first-time, review-less sender — flagged here as an **estimate adjustment**, since these figures come from tool vendors with an incentive to show strong numbers.

Why it fits ICP #1/#2: Most Lviv preschools and dental clinics run an Instagram page even without a polished website — DMs reach an actual human faster than email in this market, and referencing a specific recent post is easy personalization.

Template (preschool/dental clinic, Ukrainian):

Привіт! Побачив(ла) вашу сторінку — гарні фото з [конкретний нещодавній пост, наприклад "святкування Дня Незалежності" / "нового кабінету"]. Я допомагаю малому бізнесу у Львові з рекламою та соцмережами (нещодавно — садочку Junior School, перші заявки за місяць). Можу безкоштовно глянути ваш профіль і надіслати 2-3 конкретні ідеї, як залучити більше клієнтів — цікаво?

Follow-up (Day 3, if seen/no reply): "Не хочу набридати — якщо колись стане цікаво, просто напишіть 😊"

2.4 Google Maps Prospecting (list-building engine for ICP #1 and #2)

This is how the local prospect list actually gets built — it's the input to §2.1 and §2.3, not a separate outreach channel on its own.

Method:

1. Search Google Maps for category + city terms: "дитячий садок Львів," "приватний садочок"

Львів," "стоматологія Львів," "стоматологічна клініка Львів," and English equivalents for

Ireland/Netherlands testing ("preschool Dublin," "tandarts Amsterdam").

2. Use a free scraping tool (e.g., a Maps-to-Sheets browser extension offering ~100 free leads/day) to export: business name, category, address, phone, website (yes/no), Instagram/Facebook link, star rating, review count.

3. **Prioritize businesses with low ratings or few reviews** — research shows these businesses are more likely to be actively struggling and open to help, not less ([Clay.com — Scraping Google Maps for Leads](#)). A 3.8★ dental clinic with 12 reviews is a better prospect than a 4.9★ clinic with 400 reviews.

4. Flag businesses with **no website or a broken one** — these are Launch-tier (\$200) candidates where a Google Business Profile + basic social package is the easy first sell.

5. Cross-reference on LinkedIn/Instagram to find the actual decision-maker's name before outreach — "Hi [Name]" always outperforms "Hi there."

Weekly target: 40-60 new qualified local leads added to the tracking sheet per week during weeks 1-4, tapering as the list of realistic Lviv-area prospects gets exhausted (this is a finite market — expect the local list to be largely worked through by week 8-10, which is exactly when EU cold email should be at full ramp).

2.5 Communities (credibility-building + occasional soft leads, not a primary volume channel)

- **Local:** Lviv/Ukraine small-business Telegram/Facebook groups and entrepreneur chats — join and provide genuine value (answer marketing questions) before ever posting an offer.
- **Ireland/Netherlands:** relevant local small-business Facebook groups, Reddit communities (r/smallbusiness, country-specific business subreddits), and Chamber-of-Commerce-adjacent LinkedIn groups.
- **Practice:** lurk and contribute for the first 2-3 weeks in any community before posting anything promotional — this is the norm in agency-owner and small-business communities and the fastest way to get flagged as spam otherwise ([Grow Your Agency Group — community guide](#)).
- **Expected yield:** low volume, high trust — treat as a background activity (30-60 min/week), not a KPI-bearing channel in the weekly targets below.

2.6 Referral Ask to the 3 Existing Testimonial Clients (Week 1 priority — highest-converting channel available)

Why this comes first: referred B2B leads close at a **50-70% win rate vs. 10-20% for cold leads**, convert lead-to-sale at roughly **11%** vs. much lower for cold channels, and close in a **35% shorter sales cycle** ([ReferralRock, 2025](#); [GrowSurf, 2026](#)). This is the single highest-leverage, zero-cost action available in week 1 — it should go out before any cold outreach.

Template (personalized per client, sent Day 1-2):

preschool or child-development-center owners in Lviv (or elsewhere) who might want help getting more inquiries the way we did for you? Happy to give them the same free audit we'd give anyone, just a warm intro would mean a lot. No pressure at all either way!

To Mary:

Hi Mary, so glad the book batch sold out! If any other authors or small creative businesses in your circle are looking for help getting the word out on their next launch, I'd love an intro — happy to run them a free audit, no obligation.

To Alex:

Hi Alex, hope the social channels are still performing well. Quick ask — do you know any other founders or businesses (construction or otherwise) who could use help with ads or social? Would really appreciate an intro if anyone comes to mind.

Also ask, separately and explicitly (only once results are visible/stable), for:

1. A short written testimonial quote usable on the site and in outreach (if not already captured verbatim).
2. A **Google review** on Vike's Google Business Profile (now live) — critical since Vike has zero reviews today.
3. Permission to be named specifically in outreach to similar businesses (see honesty note in §5).

3. The Free Growth Audit — offer spec

Positioning: the audit is the *hook*, not the product — it exists to get a 15-minute call, not to give away the full strategy for free. It should feel personal and specific, never automated/generic (personalization is repeatedly the single biggest lever across every benchmark cited above).

Exactly what it contains (all delivered using free/low-cost tools, consistent with Vike's budget constraint):

1. **Google Business Profile check** — completeness, category accuracy, photos, posting activity, review count/response rate.
2. **Website snapshot** — mobile experience, page speed (via free Google PageSpeed Insights), basic on-page SEO (title tags, meta description), and — honestly — whether the site is indexed at all (using this to demonstrate the exact expertise Vike needs for its own site).
3. **Current ad activity check** — whether the business is running Meta/Google ads at all (via free Meta Ad Library search) and, if so, an obvious gap or two.
4. **Social presence snapshot** — posting frequency/consistency and engagement on their most active platform.
5. **2-3 competitor quick-glance** — one line each on what 2-3 local/direct competitors are doing differently (ads running, review count, posting cadence).
6. **3 prioritized, concrete recommendations** — the deliverable's core value; specific enough to prove expertise, general enough that execution still requires Vike.

Delivery format: a short screen-recorded video walkthrough (8-12 minutes, free tool) plus a one-page PDF summary of the 3 recommendations. Video outperforms a static PDF alone because it's harder to fake/template and builds more trust from a zero-review agency.

Time to deliver: estimate — roughly 60-90 minutes of founder time per audit (30-45 min research across the 5 checks above, 15-20 min recording, 15 min PDF write-up). No external benchmark exists for this specific scope/solo-founder combination, so this is Vike's own estimate, not a cited statistic. At 16 hrs/week, this caps realistic audit output at roughly **6-10 full audits per week** if audits were the only activity — in practice, audits should be reserved for prospects who've shown real interest (replied positively), not sent unsolicited, to protect founder time.

Pitch script for the 15-minute call that follows a well-received audit:

"So those are the 3 things I found — happy to just leave it there if it's useful as-is. If you'd rather someone handle the fix (and the ongoing work), that's what we do — plans start at \$200/month, month-to-month, no contract, you can stop anytime. Want me to walk you through what that would actually look like for [Business Name] specifically?"

Benchmark context on free-audit-as-lead-magnet conversion: free audits used as business-development tools convert at roughly **10-15% top-of-funnel to paid engagement**, rising to **30%+ when the audit is personalized and followed by a structured proposal conversation** rather than left to sit ([Intertec Data Solutions, 2026](#)). Vike should target the higher end of this range by always following an audit with a live call rather than just emailing the PDF.

4. Pricing/Offer Notes

Baseline instruction respected: the three real price points (\$200 Launch / \$400 Scale / \$750 Dominate) stay exactly as they are. Nothing below changes them — these are framing suggestions only, each explicitly flagged.

1. **Suggestion — anchor with Dominate first (pricing psychology, not a cited statistic):** when presenting the three tiers verbally or on a pricing page, lead with Dominate (\$750), then Scale (\$400), then Launch (\$200) — the classic anchoring/decoy effect, where showing the highest tier first makes the middle tier feel like the reasonable, considered choice rather than the "cheap option." This is a well-established consumer-psychology principle; no fresh 2026 statistic was found specifically validating it for this scenario, so it's flagged as a **best-practice suggestion, not a verified benchmark**.
2. **Suggestion — explicit "pilot" framing for the first 3-5 clients (estimate/best-practice, not a cited statistic):** Vike already has no-contract, month-to-month pricing, which is a real risk-reducer — but naming it explicitly as a "30-day pilot" in the sales conversation (rather than just "no contract") may reduce hesitation further for a review-less agency, since it reframes the first month as a low-stakes test rather than a commitment. No direct statistic was found quantifying this framing's lift; it is grounded in the general finding that lower perceived risk correlates with faster referral-style closes (\$2.6 sources) but this specific application is Vike's own inference, labeled **estimate**.
3. **No change recommended to the actual price levels.** At \$200-750/month, Vike is priced well below typical Irish SME digital marketing budgets (€600-3,000/month, [VIMAR](#)) and fits **Ukrainian SME budgets** appropriately — there is no evidence in this research that the price

points themselves are a barrier; the barrier is trust/proof, which §3 and §6 address directly rather than through pricing changes.

5. Pilot / Case-Study Strategy — turning the first 1-3 results into shareable proof

Vike has zero formal case studies today. The plan to fix this within 90 days:

1. **Week 1, for every new client signed:** set up a simple before/after tracking doc (baseline metrics on day 1 — lead volume, follower count, ad spend/results if applicable — captured *before* any work starts, so the "after" comparison is honest and verifiable).
2. **At the 3-4 week mark of each new client:** check for any early, real, specific result (even small — "12 inquiry-form submissions in the first 3 weeks," "engagement up 40% on Instagram"). Draft a one-page case study: Client type → Problem → What Vike did → Specific, real number → short client quote.
3. **Ask permission before publishing anything** — every case study and every use of a client's name in outreach materials should be explicitly approved by that client first. This is especially important where a client's name might be used in outreach to their direct competitors (e.g., referencing "Junior School" by name when emailing other Lviv preschools could reasonably feel uncomfortable to them) — always confirm comfort with that specific use, not just a general "can I use your name" ask.
4. **Once a result is visible and the client is happy, ask for (in this order):**
 - A specific written testimonial quote (more usable than a vague "great service!" line).
 - A Google review on Vike's GBP (existing testimonials from Junior School/Mary/Alex should also be converted into the *first* Google reviews if those clients are willing — this single action would take Vike from zero to some reviews almost immediately, which per §0 is one of the most urgent fixes available).
 - A Clutch review once the Clutch profile clears review (check status weekly).
 - Permission to publish the one-page case study on the (eventually indexed) site and reference it in future outreach.
5. **Recycle proof immediately into every channel:** each new case study should be worked into the cold email templates (§2.1), LinkedIn posts, and the free-audit pitch script within days of being approved — proof that's sitting unused is proof that isn't compounding.

6. Weekly Targets & KPIs — Weeks 1-13 (Day 1-90)

Honesty notes before the table:

- Reply-rate assumptions below use the researched benchmarks (§2) but adjust upward modestly for small-batch, hand-personalized local outreach (§2.3 personalization effect) and downward for cold EU email in its first weeks of use — these adjustments are **estimates**, clearly distinguished from the cited benchmark ranges.

✓ **Audit to close conversion** assumes the higher end of the benchmark range (personalized audit +

live call, §3) but even so, expect the *early* weeks to underperform this as the sales process and templates are still being refined — treat weeks 1-4 numbers as a floor, not a target to be alarmed about missing.

- Positive-reply-to-booked-call and audit-to-close ratios below are Vike's own **estimates**, since no benchmark source reports these specific downstream steps for a brand-new, review-less agency.

Week	Days	Primary Focus	Actions & Volume Targets	KPI Targets (estimate unless cited)	Milestone
1	1-7	Foundation: referral asks, list-building, email warm-up start	Send 3 personalized referral asks (§2.6) same day. Build Google Maps lists: 40-60 preschools + dental clinics (§2.4). Start cold-email domain warm-up (SPF/DKIM/DMARC + warm-up tool, ~5-10/day automated, not client-facing yet). Optimize LinkedIn profile. Join 3-5 local communities (lurk only). Send 15-20 personalized Instagram DMs/emails to local prospects.	3 referral asks sent · 15-20 local outreach sends · 40-60 leads added to tracker · 0-2 replies (est., ~10-15% on warm local outreach)	Referral asks out day 1-2
2	8-14	Local outreach ramp + LinkedIn start	Follow-up touch on week-1 non-responders. 20-25 new local Instagram DM/email sends. Start LinkedIn: 15 connection requests/week with personalized notes to Ireland/NL SMB owners. 1 value post on LinkedIn (share a real, true proof point).	3-5 total replies across local channels (est.) · 15 LinkedIn connections sent, ~4-6 accepted (21-38% benchmark, Expandi.io) · 1-2 free audits delivered	First audit delivered
3	15-21	First close push	Continue local sends (20-25/week) + follow-ups. Deliver audits to all positive local replies. First sales calls/DMs pushing toward close. Continue LinkedIn connections (15/week) + first post-acceptance messages.	2-3 audits delivered · 1-2 live sales conversations · target: 1 verbal "yes" or signed client by end of week	Target: first client signed

Week	Days	Primary Focus	Actions & Volume Targets	KPI Targets (estimate unless cited)	Milestone
4	22-30	Close + EU email ramp begins	If not yet closed, concentrated push on warmest 3-5 local leads. Email domain should be warmed (3-4 wks, Mailforge.ai) — begin real EU cold email at low volume: ~20-25 personalized sends/week to Ireland/NL SMBs. Set up first client's baseline tracking doc immediately on signing.	Day-30 goal: 1 client signed (Launch or Scale tier) · 20-25 EU cold emails sent, target 2-4 replies (est. 10-15% for small hand-personalized batch, above the 3.43% platform average per Instantly.ai) · pipeline of 3-5 warm local conversations	30-day milestone: 1 client
5	31-37	Scale local + EU email steady	Continue local Maps prospecting (remaining unworked leads) + Instagram DMs (15-20/week). EU cold email steady at 25-30/week with 3-touch sequence (\$2.1). LinkedIn: 15-20 connections/week, post-acceptance messages to all accepted.	4-6 EU email replies cumulative (est.) · 1-2 new local audits delivered · target: 1 additional client conversation reaching proposal stage	
6	38-44	First case-study draft	Check client #1 for early real results; draft one-page case study (\$6.5 process). Continue all channels at week-5 volumes. Ask client #1 for a Google review if results are visible.	Case study draft complete · 1 Google review requested · outreach volumes held steady · target: client #2 signed	Target: client #2
7	45-51	Referral loop re-activated	Once client #1 has visible progress, send an explicit referral ask (separate from week-1 general ask) referencing the specific result. Continue local + EU + LinkedIn at steady volumes.	1 new referral ask sent · continued 25-30 EU emails/week, 15-20 local sends/week	
8	52-60	Day-60 push	Concentrated push on all open pipeline (local + EU + LinkedIn) to convert warm leads before day 60. Deliver any pending audits within 48 hrs of request.	Day-60 goal: 3-4 clients signed cumulative · case study #1 published (with permission) and worked into all templates	60-day milestone: 3-4 clients
9	61-67	Case study #2 + Clutch push	Draft case study for client #2 if results visible. Check Clutch profile status; request Clutch review from earliest client if profile is live. Continue EU cold	1 Clutch review requested (if profile approved) · 2nd case study drafted · EU reply rate tracked	

Week	Days	Primary Focus	Actions & Volume Targets	KPI Targets (estimate unless cited)	Milestone
			email (30-35/week) — now with a real case study to cite, expect reply rate to trend toward the upper end of the 5-10% "good" benchmark range.	against 5%+ good/10%+ top benchmark (Instantly.ai)	
10	68-74	Local list refresh + e-commerce test	Local Lviv list likely nearing exhaustion (\$2.4) — refresh with adjacent niches (e.g., tutoring centers, pediatric clinics) using same Maps method. Begin small test batch (10-15) of e-commerce SMB outreach using construction/social-proof angle from Alex's testimonial.	10-15 e-commerce test sends · continued EU + LinkedIn volumes	
11	75-81	Capacity check-in	Explicit gut-check (see §7 capacity math): tally hours spent on service delivery for current clients vs. hours left for prospecting. Adjust outreach volume down if service time is crowding out sales time — protecting existing clients' quality matters more than raw new-lead volume.	Capacity audit completed · outreach volume adjusted accordingly	
12	82-88	Final push + review collection	Concentrated push on all remaining warm pipeline. Collect any outstanding Google/Clutch reviews from clients 1-3. Publish case study #2/#3 if ready.	1-2 additional reviews collected · target: client #5-6 signed	
13	89-90	Day-90 review	Full pipeline and funnel review: total sends by channel, replies, audits, calls, closes — compare actuals to benchmarks cited throughout this plan and recalibrate weeks 14+ targets accordingly.	Day-90 realistic target: 5-8 clients cumulative (see §7 for why 10 is a stretch, not base case)	90-day milestone: 5-8 clients (realistic), 10 (stretch)

7. Capacity Reality Check — why "10 clients" needs a caveat

The brief asks for a path to the first 10 clients. Presented honestly: **10 clients by day 90, solo, at 16 hrs/week, is an upper-bound stretch goal, not the realistic base case.**

Back-of-envelope math (all figures in this section are Vike's own **estimates** — no external benchmark exists for solo-founder service-delivery time at this specific price tier):

- Estimated service-delivery time per client/week: Launch (~\$200) ≈ 1.5-2 hrs/week (lighter management); Scale (~\$400) ≈ 2.5-3 hrs/week; Dominate (~\$750) ≈ 4-5 hrs/week (creative production + SEO + more channels).
- At a blended estimate of ~2.5 hrs/week/client, **6 concurrent clients ≈ 15 hrs/week** — nearly the entire 16-hour budget, leaving almost no time for new prospecting, audits, or sales calls.
- This means the sales engine and the service-delivery load compete directly for the same hours. Realistically, somewhere around **6-8 concurrent clients is close to solo capacity** at this weekly hour budget, assuming reasonably efficient, templated service delivery.
- Reaching 10 within 90 days would most likely require either (a) leaner average service time per client than estimated above, (b) formally onboarding the cofounder friend or UGC creator to take real hours off Vladyslav's plate, or (c) accepting lower-touch/lighter-service clients weighted toward the Launch tier.
- **Recommendation:** treat 10 as the plan's directional target and keep pushing toward it, but don't treat falling short of it by day 90 as a failure signal — 5-8 real, well-served, review-generating clients by day 90 is a strong, defensible outcome given the true solo/16-hr starting position, and is a better foundation for the next 90 days (with reviews and case studies compounding) than 10 clients served poorly.

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